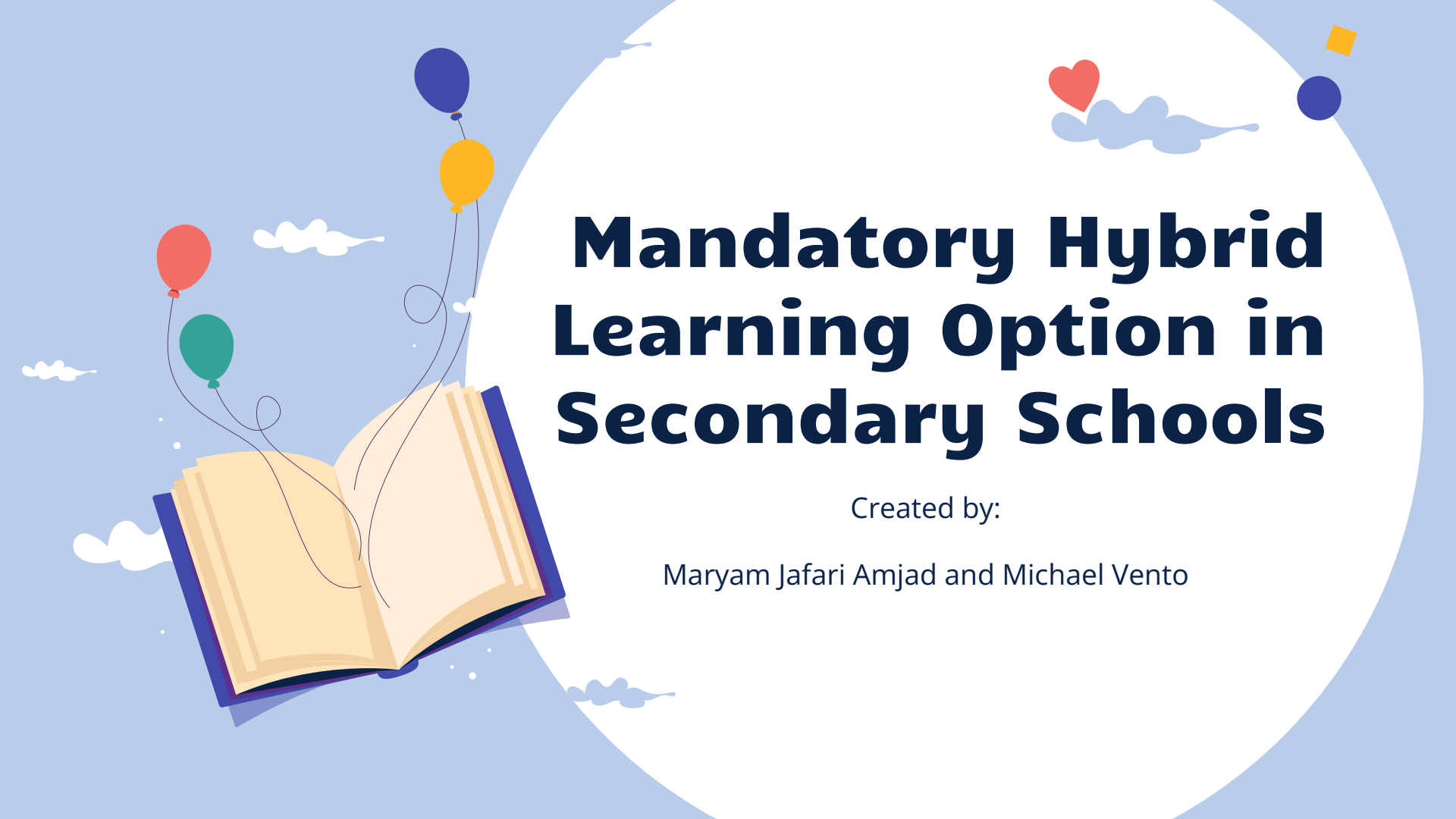




Mandatory Hybrid Learning Option in Secondary Schools

Created by:

Maryam Jafari Amjad and Michael Vento



Introduction



Hybrid learning is when a synchronous class is conducted with participants attending both in person and/or virtually as desired. This learning style has seen continued growth within institutions throughout the COVID-19 pandemic. Hybrid learning throughout secondary institutions would enhance education options for students and give them freedom of choice over their preferred learning methods. The implementation of hybrid learning would help students by diminishing financial strain, increasing flexibility, and reducing commute times.

Current Situation

This is an issue to be put before . . . the Honourable Rachna Singh, MP, Minister of Education and Childcare in the Province of British Columbia

Legislation in question . . . The [*British Columbia School Act*](#) is a provincial statute governing primary and secondary education in British Columbia.

- *Particular attention to Section 75 of the [*British Columbia School Act*](#)*

Section 75 (4.1) of BC School Act

Section 75: “Provisions of Educational Programming” (4.1) declares that “a board may deliver an educational program, or part of an educational program, through online learning to the following persons only if the board has approval to provide the educational program under an agreement with the minister:

(a) a student, as defined in the [*Independent School Act*](#)²: “a person enrolled in an independent school”

(b) a student who is enrolled in an educational program provided by another board, or a francophone student

(c) a student who is not resident in the board’s school district

(d) a child who is registered under section 13 with a school operated by another board, a francophone school or independent school.

Key Issues

- There is no provision for part-online (hybrid) learning for students who attend public school, live in that school board's district, and are not registered under section 13 (provision for registration for francophone/independent schools/etc). **Why exclude in-house students from hybrid learning?**
- Each Board requires approval for part-online (hybrid) learning from the Minister/Provincial government. **Why is this necessary? Does this serve as a deterrent to hybrid learning?**

Positive Aspects of Hybrid Learning in Secondary Schools

Positive aspects to hybrid learning include:

- Increased flexibility for both students and teachers
- Diminished financial strain (commuting costs)
- Time efficiency (less commute times)
- Environmental benefits → Less CO₂ emissions due to less commute
- Implementation of more multifaceted, inclusive learning

Negative Aspects of Hybrid Learning in Secondary Schools

Negative aspects to hybrid learning include . . .

- Privacy concerns regarding lecture recordings and discussions in a private lesson
- Instructors and learning environment may feel alienating and the loss connecting

Recommendation: Revision to BC School Act

A revision to Section 75 (4.1) of the [British Columbia School Act](#) that would read the following . . .

Section 75: “Provisions of Educational Programming” (4.1): a board must provide an option to deliver an educational program through a hybrid learning system to the following persons:

(a) a student, as defined in the [British Columbia School Act](#)

“student” means a person enrolled in an educational program provided by a board and, if a section or subsection refers to a Provincial school, includes a person enrolled in the Provincial school for the purposes of that section or subsection”

a student, as defined in the [Independent School Act](#): “a person enrolled in an independent school”

(b) a student who is enrolled in an educational program provided by another board, or a francophone student

(c) a student who is not resident in the board’s school district

(d) a child who is registered under section 13 with a school operated by another board, a francophone school or independent school.

(e) a student who has completed their primary education and is currently or will be enrolled in a secondary education facility

Recommendation: Revision to BC School Act continued . . .

A new subsection: Section 75 (4.2) . . .

(4.2) All board's must provide the students relevant under Section 75 (4.1) with option to attend in-person, hybrid, or completely remote, as per the hybrid learning system

- (a) A student must declare their method of learning from the hybrid learning options at the beginning of the year
- (b) A student cannot change or revise their chosen method of learning NOTWITHSTANDING extraordinary or unforeseen circumstances
- (c) A student who declares a hybrid or completely remote method of learning may be given an asynchronous option, depending upon the circumstances and the instructor's preferences



Consequences

This revision to Section 75 (4.1) allows students attending public school who reside in the school district's region to participate in hybrid learning. Additionally, this change requires public/independent schools within the province to provide in-person, hybrid, and virtual options (under the umbrella of hybrid learning). Additionally, this revision creates an additional subsection to Section 75: (4.2), for clarification on the hybrid learning system.

References

“About BC Independent Schools.” FISA BC (Federation of Independent Schools Association). Accessed March 23, 2023. <https://fisabc.ca/who-are-weabout-bc-independent-schools/>

Canada. British Columbia. Ministry of Education. *School Act: Revised Statutes of British Columbia*. 1996. <https://www2.gov.bc.ca/assets/gov/education/administration/legislation-policy/legislation/schoollaw/revisedstatutescontents.pdf>

Canada. British Columbia. Ministry of Education. *Independent School Act*. 1996. https://www.bclaws.gov.bc.ca/civix/document/id/complete/statreg/96216_01#section1

Mehta, Kashish, and Accessible Course Practices. Personal interview with the author. 28 Mar. 2022.

Ontario Human Rights Commission. “Policy on Accessible Education for Students with Disabilities,” Policy on accessible education for students with disabilities. Accessed March 15, 2023. <https://www.ohrc.on.ca/en/policy-accessible-education-students-disabilities>

Snitz, Ron. Personal interview with the author. 18 Mar. 2022.